



# POOL

FUTURA REMIX HACKATHON 2026 · NATIONAL FINAL

## Swipe on things you'd do — not people.

Pool puts shy UNSW students into a squad of 2–4 around something concrete — a deadline, a hobby, a society event — then finds a time everyone is free and a public spot on campus. **Nobody has to make the first move.**



### Try it live

Scan · tap **Try it as a guest**  
no install needed

[pool-app-gules.vercel.app](https://pool-app-gules.vercel.app)

Team Exit Music  
Cecilia N · Harry N · Mia V · Phu D

#### THE PROBLEM

The barrier isn't opportunity. It's the first move.

94%

wanted a friend or study partner in class but **didn't know how to start**

80%

said what stopped them was being **too shy to approach**

88%

had **already joined a society** — the problem stayed

82%

said they would **use Pool** if it launched today

Survey of 17 UNSW students, September 2026 — directional, not conclusive.

“Every other option ends at ‘**you can now message each other**’. Pool ends at a time and a place.”

Discord, course Facebook groups and clubs all assume you can walk up to a stranger.

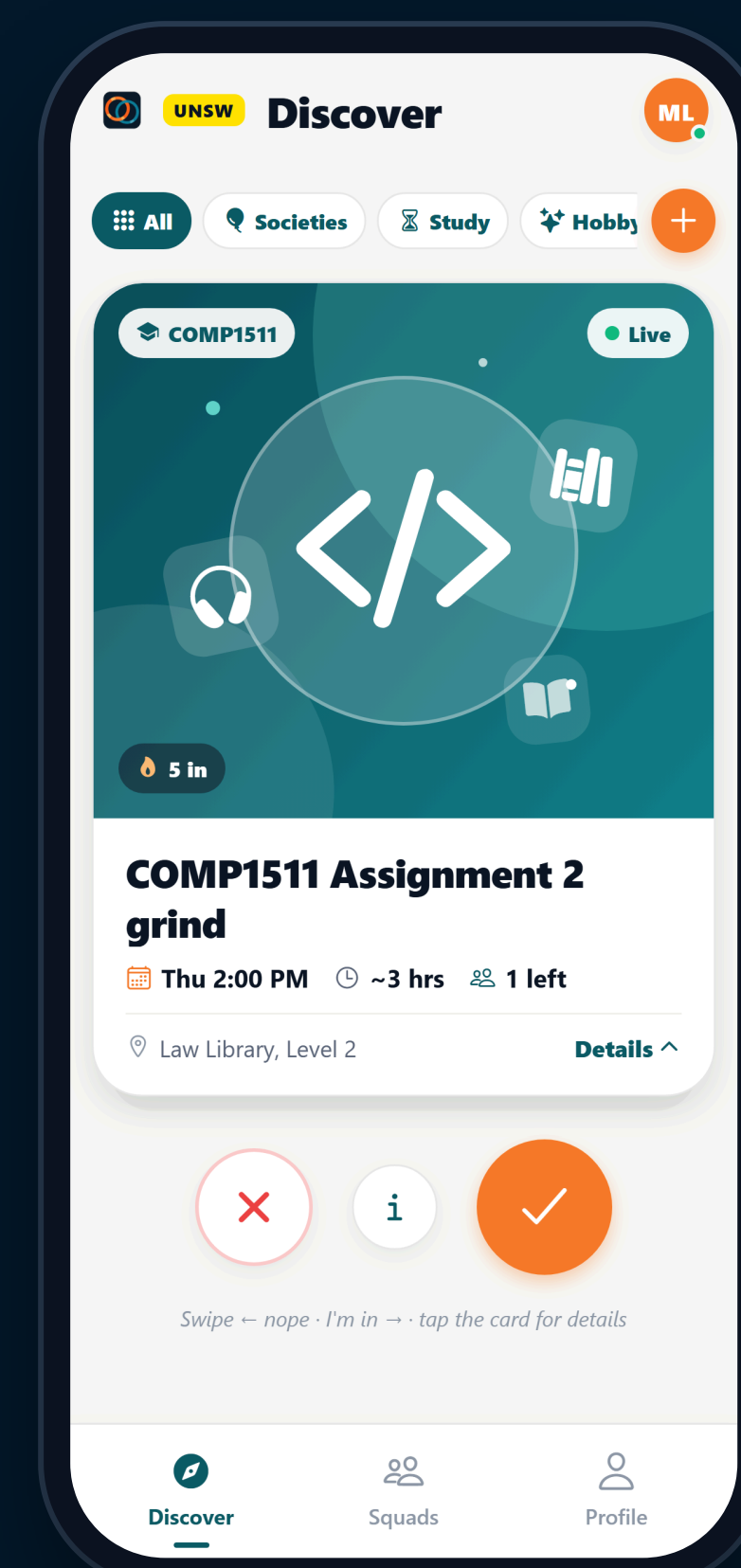
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#### WHO IT'S FOR

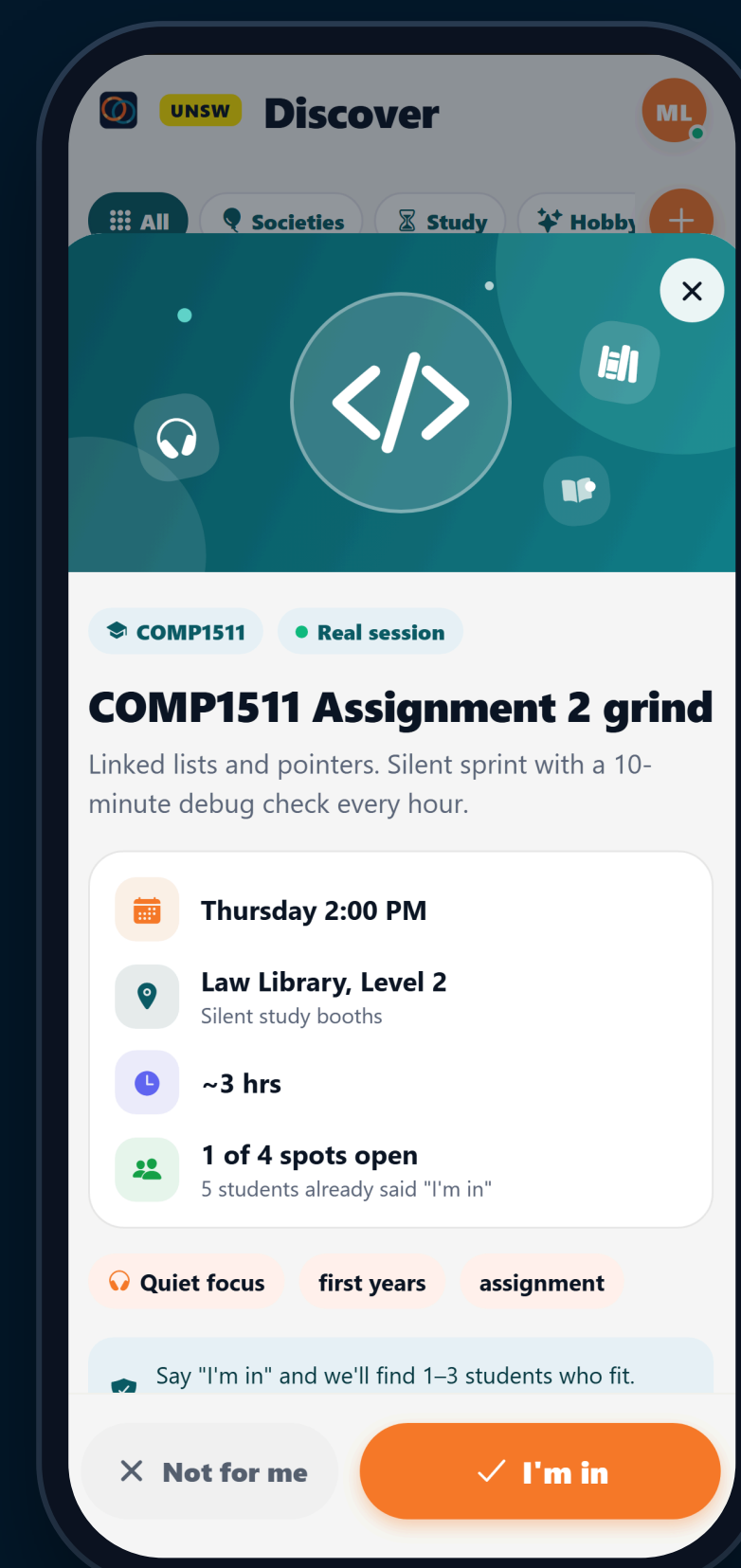
**Maya, first-year Software Engineering.** Week 4, assignment due Friday, doesn't know one person in her 400-person lecture. Too shy to message a stranger — happy to show up if the group is already formed.

#### THE PRODUCT — LIVE, NOT A MOCK-UP

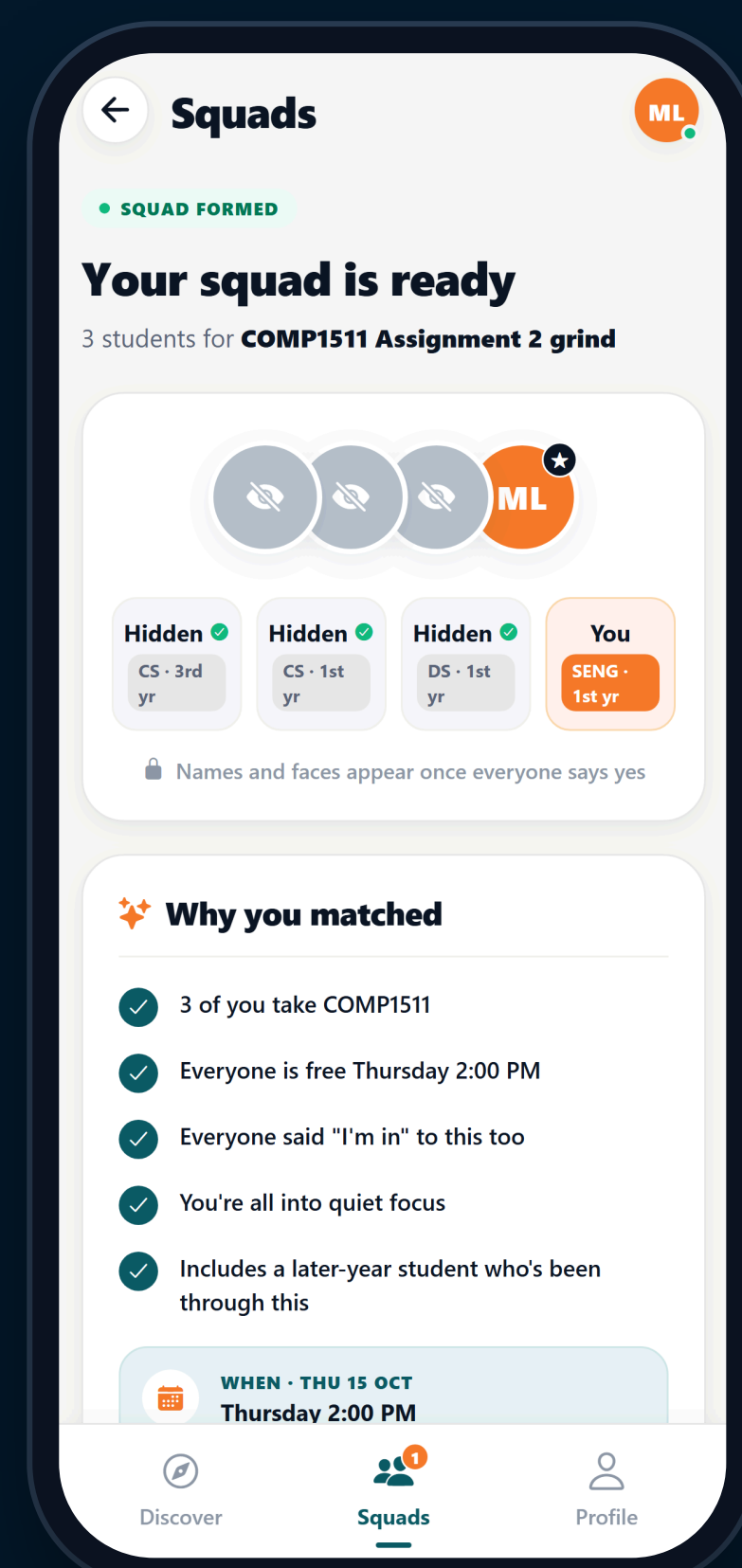
From a swipe to a real meetup in four taps



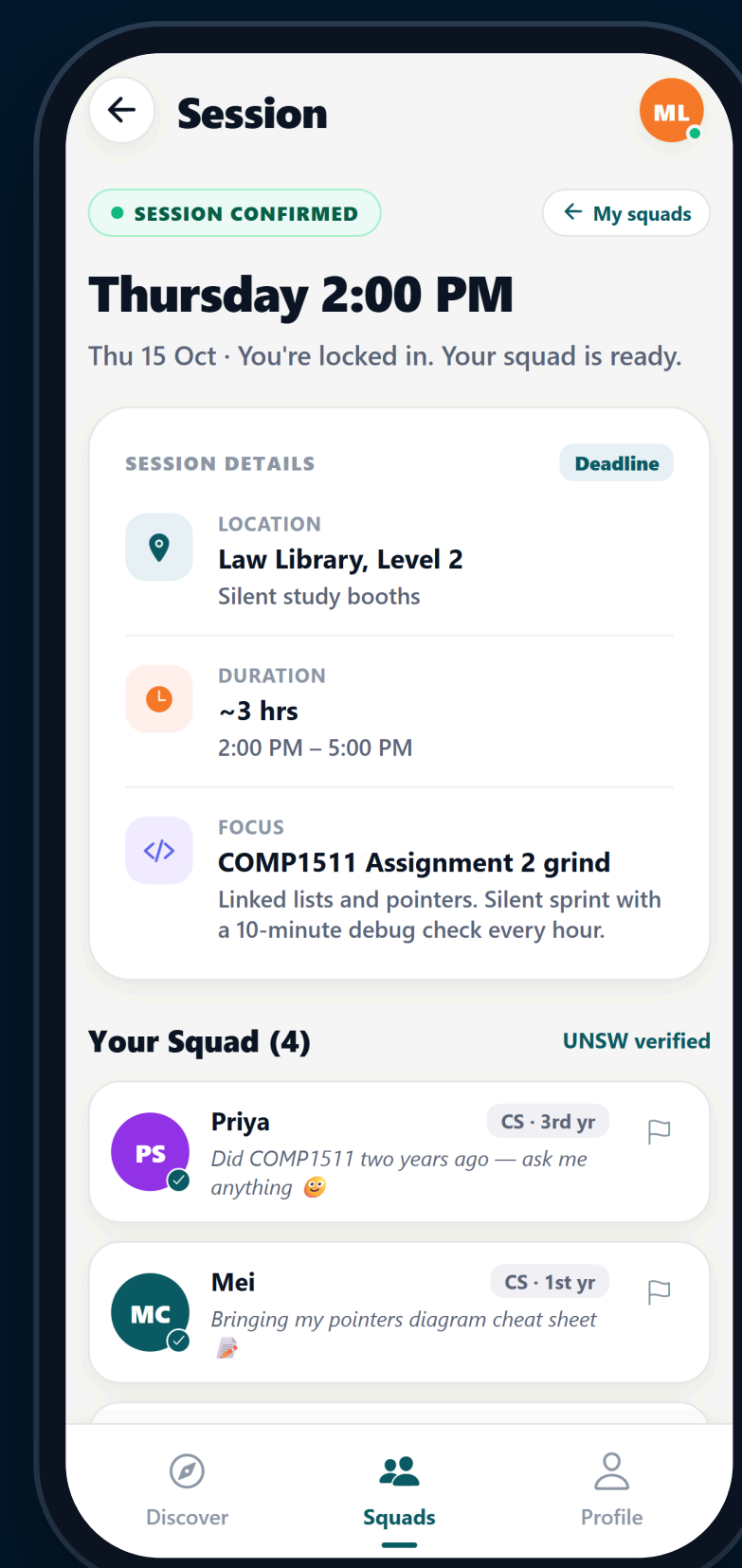
**1 Swipe activities**  
Study, hobby, career and society events — never faces.



**2 Tap for details**  
When, where, how many are in. Then “I'm in”.



**3 Squad forms**  
Names hidden until all say yes — and it says why you matched.



**4 Meet up**  
Real time, public venue, squad chat and “I'm here” check-in.

#### HOW IT WORKS END TO END



#### TECHNOLOGY

A real stack, **phone to database**



#### FRONTEND

**React Native + Expo**

TypeScript · one codebase for iPhone, Android and web



#### BACKEND

**Supabase**

Auth (UNSW only) · matching engine, scheduler & metrics as SQL functions



#### DATABASE

**PostgreSQL**

Swipes, squads, ratings, chat · text similarity on “in your own words”

GitHub → auto-deploys to **Vercel** · today a web app, next the **App Store & Google Play** from the same code

#### PRIVACY & SAFETY BY DESIGN

- UNSW students only** — enforced by the database
- No profile browsing** — names & photos appear only after everyone says yes
- Public campus venues only** — no inbox, no cold DMs
- Report & block** in one tap · **delete your data** in two

#### PATH TO ADOPTION

- 1 One COMP1511 tutorial**  
20–50 students · prove they turn up
- 2 1–2 first-year courses**  
QR on Moodle · tutor mention
- 3 First-year cohort**  
O-Week stall · standee at the gate
- 4 All of UNSW**  
Arc & societies as partners

#### MEASURED LIVE



Every step is a database query — plus weekly cohorts & churn.

#### THE NEXT 6 MONTHS

- Ship**  
App Store & Google Play from the same code
- Integrate**  
UNSW Microsoft sign-in, Handbook course list
- Smarter**  
Claude-written match explanations
- Test**  
Pilot in one tutorial; measure show-up rate
- Partner**  
Verified society accounts post their events
- Grow**  
Café perks for squads; Arc pilot

#### WHY POOL IS DIFFERENT

**Dating apps** — swipe on faces, one-to-one, cold first message.

**Clubs & group chats** — you still have to walk up to a stranger.

**Pool** — activities, not people. The squad arrives already formed, with a reason, a time and a place.